

and other tweaks. Straightforward, and more importantly, easy. Why shouldn't you hack?

PMP

PMPs are peculiar devices, really. They were envisioned as handheld devices that were supposed to play your digital entertainment media. Songs, videos, some games, maybe, but that's it. Leave it to Apple, though to revolutionize an industry. In comes the iPod, out goes all perceptions of what a PMP is.

Today, for all we know, a respectable PMP is a smartphone minus the calling facility. Which makes us, sad, really, so don't worry – we will tell you how to make a call through your WiFi enabled PMP, later. But, taking things one at a time, not all PMPs are suitably capable, as of today. They have the hardware, and hence the potential, for better performance. Which is what drives projects like RockBox, which aim to create better, more capable environment in even the less flashy of PMP devices. RockBox has been trying to give provide a powerful interface, along with the promise of better



audio and video rendering. Currently, a host of devices are supported, and while availability of many more are on the way. Head over to www.rockbox.org to know more about the project. And be sure to read our chapter on hacking PMPs.

Camera

Cameras of the modern day are criminally underestimated devices. In terms of hardware, they are being installed with pretty capable components, but for some bizarre reason, they seem to install software that does not make efficient use of all that is available to it. There are theories that it is a sales strategy, that if lower-end cameras carried full-blown features, then the high-end market would suffer. But if that is the case, then the companies should have been stringent with the hardware too. But they were not, and the result is that various hacking groups have been hard at work to develop custom firmware for these cameras, which harness the possibilities that the devices offer. One of the pioneers of this movement is the CHDK – the Canon Hack Development Kit, which is built to empower the low and mid-